NADIA BRENNAN-AZIZ

Senior Site Reliability / Platform Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior platform and reliability engineer with 10 years of infrastructure experience, including six years operating Kubernetes platforms on AWS. Experienced in hands-on cloud infrastructure engineering, AWS environment design and operation, Terraform, observability, reliability, and incident management; tech lead for a five-person platform team, with a record of shaping technical approaches and agreeing reliability practices with product leadership, while building self-service infrastructure and practical operating processes that help product teams deploy and run services reliably. Led a Karpenter and Spot migration that reduced EC2 spend by 38%.

LANGUAGES

English (native) | Urdu (conversational)

Technical Toolkit

AWS: EKS, EC2, VPC, IAM, RDS, S3, SQS, Route 53, CloudFront
Networking: VPC, Route 53, CloudFront
Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Atlantis
Platforms and Systems Architecture: Kubernetes, Helm, Kustomize, Argo CD, Crossplane, Karpenter
Reliability and observability: SLOs, error budgets, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, OpenTelemetry, incident management
Programming and automation: Go, Python, Bash, GitHub Actions, Puppet
Testing and capacity planning: k6
Systems: Linux

EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer | Tallybrook Ltd | Manchester / remote
Apr 2022 – Present

- Technical lead of the five-person platform team, responsible for operating an AWS EKS platform spanning 8 clusters, approximately 350 services and 3 regions; participate in the incident commander rotation and wrote the incident and post-mortem process.
- Designed and built the internal developer platform with Go and Python service templates, Argo CD GitOps, and Crossplane self-service for RDS, SQS and S3. Adopted by all 14 product teams; reduced the time from new service to production from approximately two weeks to under one day.
- Led the move from cluster-autoscaler managed node groups to Karpenter, using Spot instances for stateless workloads with interruption handling. Reduced EC2 spend by 38% (approximately £410,000 per year).
- Introduced SLOs and burn-rate alerts for the 20 most critical services using Prometheus recording rules and Sloth. Agreed the error-budget policy with product leadership; reduced on-call pages per week by approximately 60%.

Site Reliability Engineer | Brightwater Games | Leeds
Jan 2019 – Mar 2022

- Operated AWS game-backend infrastructure using EC2, ECS and later EKS for titles with up to 1.2 million daily active players.
- Managed AWS infrastructure in Terraform, with approximately 40 modules; used Atlantis to run plan and apply workflows on pull requests.
- Replaced a noisy Nagios setup with a Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager and Loki observability stack.
- Ran k6 load tests and led capacity planning ahead of launches. For a 2020 launch, tests simulating 300,000 concurrent players exposed a connection-pool limit that was fixed before launch.

SELECTED PROJECT

Kubernetes Preview-Namespace Cleanup Operator | Open source side project | 2024

- Built a small Kubernetes controller in Go using controller-runtime to delete expired preview namespaces; the project has approximately 120 GitHub stars.

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY

- Mentored three engineers transitioning from backend development into SRE.
- Speaker at a UK DevOps meetup in 2024: “SLOs that product managers care about”.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

BSc Computer Science | University of the North Moors | 2016

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | 2021, renewed 2024
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional | 2023